

CHAPTER

8

OWN THE DAY

Breakfast Recipes for a Great Start

How you start the morning sets the tone for the entire day. Don't waste the opportunity to make the most of it.

Breakfast is the first meal of the day, and its timing is critical. Your body would rather have you eat food after a workout than before. Many of us are accustomed to waking up and eating, which is okay if you don't plan to train. The only time you would eat breakfast before you train is if you have at least a two-hour window from breakfast until your workout.

Realize that once you're done eating, you will be left with two more meals for the day. When you wake up, have coffee or tea if you want, but don't add anything to it that has over 10 calories total. If you take in over 10 calories, you will spike your insulin levels.

Let's face it: Many of us don't have a lot of time in the morning before our workouts anyway. So if you're not hungry first thing in the morning, you can wait to eat about an hour or two after you wake up. You will be burning fat the entire time you're up, until you take your first bite of food. What is key is to then have at least a five-hour break before the next time you eat.

PICK YOUR MEAL TIMING FOR YOUR LIFESTYLE

Carefully planning your meal times is essential to making my nutrition plan work for you. It is also important to be honest with yourself about what meals you like most. Are you a breakfast, lunch or dinner person? You can choose to eat about the same amount of food at each sitting, but people who love breakfast might choose to eat more at breakfast and less at lunch and dinner. So keep your personal preferences in mind as you build each day's schedule.

Do not force yourself to become somebody you're not. Being true to when and what you like to eat is essential in making this nutrition plan a long-term

lifestyle change. Due to lifestyle a lot of people do not have the time to eat a large sit-down breakfast. If that's the case for you, then there are still plenty of items included in this chapter that you can eat on the run.

I've also added breakfast options I like when you have time to actually cook and eat your breakfast. It's very important to realize that food is not your enemy; it's your energy source, and you need to feed your muscles and starve your fat.

CALORIES: SHOULD YOU COUNT THEM?

I do not believe in counting every calorie you eat. But I do want you to make sure that you're eating at least 1,000 calories per day. Do not under eat. If your body does not get 1,000 calories per day, then it will conserve fat. When you do this, you will lose scale bodyweight for a while, but then you will start gaining weight at an alarming rate. And all the weight you gain will be fat not muscle.

Remember you want to lose fat—never muscle. Under eating will cause you to cannibalize muscle for energy before you tap into fat. That's true no matter your goal, gender or current bodyweight. Remember the more muscle you have, the more calories you burn.

What follows is a list of breakfast ideas, but do not limit yourself to these. Food choices are completely up to you so long as you stay within the parameters of my portion-size recommendations while adhering to the GL principles.



BREAKFAST RECIPES

YOGURT

Plain Greek yogurt 6 oz add 2 oz of any fresh berries you like:

Do not eat the yogurt with the fruit already added. Fresh fruit is better than fruit that has been sitting in yogurt for a few weeks, and fruit versions often contain added sugar.

	Calories:		
6 oz	0% fat	1% fat	2% fat
Chobani	100	n/a	130
Okios	120	n/a	n/a
Stonyfield	80	n/a	140
Wallaby	100	130	170
Fage	100	130	190

Any of these types of yogurt are fine for my program. Again, you don't need to count calories. I'm just showing you how they vary when you include differing levels of dietary fats. Choose the type you like best.

	Calories:
2 oz	
Blueberries	33
Strawberries	19
Raspberries	30
Blackberries	24
Pomegranate seeds	47
Grapes	38
Banana	50
Pineapple	28



Protein Pancakes

Ingredients:

1 scoop of protein powder (unflavored, 0 sugar)

1 egg

1 spoonful of ground flaxseed

1 teaspoon of vanilla extract

Pinch of cinnamon

Pinch of stevia

Almond milk (optional)

Greek yogurt (optional)

Instructions:

1. Add all the ingredients together.
2. Mix the batter until it reaches desired consistency. If needed, add almond milk (1 spoonful at a time to thin out the mix).
3. Then cook on griddle over low heat, flipping when the top begins to bubble.
4. Top with Greek yogurt or eat plain.

Yogurt Parfait

Ingredients:

- 1 can of unsweetened pumpkin puree**
- 2 small pears (super ripe)**
- 1 tablespoon of maple syrup**
- ¼ tablespoon of nutmeg**
- 1 cup of 0 fat Greek yogurt**
- 1 cup of rolled oats**

Instructions:

1. Blend everything except the yogurt and rolled oats in a food processor.
2. Then place the mixture in the fridge for 30 minutes.
3. Then layer the puree with the yogurt and add the rolled oats on top. *Serves 3*

EGGS

Each large egg contains about 7 g of protein and 13 essential vitamins and minerals. A large egg contains a little more than 200 mg of cholesterol, mostly from the egg yolk, and just over 70 calories. I'm not telling you to eat only one egg; I'm just showing the amount of calories so you know. I want you to eat enough food so you are satisfied and not hungry.

Keep in mind that the calorie count does not include how the eggs and vegetables are prepared. Some options are to use an old skillet so the eggs don't stick, or add canola spray to the skillet.

You can also add olive oil or butter to the skillet, but realize that these add calories and fat, but that may not be negative, depending on how much you're eating for the day. Some people like to cook eggs in their microwave.

To do this:

- coat a microwavable cup with cooking spray;
- pour in your eggs and whatever else you want to add (onions, chopped vegetables, etc.);
- microwave on high for 45 seconds then stir it around and put it back in for another 35 seconds, adjusting the time based on your microwave.

Make sure to watch your eggs the first time you cook them in your microwave!
You don't want them to boil over or blow up.

	Calories:
1 Large egg	78
1 Large egg white	17
1 Large hard-boiled egg	78
1 Large hard-boiled egg white	17
1 Egg whites with ½ cup spinach	20
1 Egg with ½ cup spinach	81
1 Egg whites with 2 oz salmon	121
1 Egg with 2 oz salmon	196
1 Egg white with 2 oz mushrooms	30
1 Egg with 2 oz mushrooms	91
1 Egg whites with 2 oz tomatoes	27
1 Egg with 2 oz tomatoes	88
1 Egg white with cheese	178
1 Egg with cheese	236
1 Egg white with broccoli	97
1 Egg with broccoli	36
1 Egg white with eggplant	31
1 Egg with eggplant	123

Healthy Pancakes

Ingredients:

2 eggs

1 medium ripe banana (230 calories)

Instructions:

1. Peel and mash up the banana until its consistency is like thick cream.
2. Then whisk in 2 whole eggs. The mix should look like liquidy eggs, not pancake batter.
3. Take 2 tablespoon of your mix and put it on a hot skillet or non-stick pan.
4. Brown the bottom of the pancake and then flip it over. This should take about 1 minute or so. If it takes longer, then turn up the heat on the stove.
5. Once both sides are golden you are done. You can also add topping like 90% or higher chocolate bits, natural peanut butter or nuts. Some people like to add in $\frac{1}{8}$ teaspoon of baking soda to the original mix to make the pancakes fluffier.

Spinach and Cheddar Quiche

Ingredients:

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup chopped spinach frozen or fresh

1 egg

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup of low-fat milk

$\frac{1}{3}$ cup of shredded cheddar cheese

A pinch of salt

Instructions:

1. If the spinach is fresh, put in 3 tablespoons of water, cook for 1 min on high then drain. If the spinach is frozen, defrost it and drain out excess water.
2. Then add in the egg, milk, cheese, and salt. Mix it together for 15 seconds.
3. Microwave on high for 3 minutes. Make sure you put a paper towel over the top of the microwavable cup you are using. *Serves 1*

COTTAGE CHEESE

Cottage cheese is packed with protein and essential amino acids. I recommend it after morning workouts because it's naturally high in leucine, which is one of the amino acids that helps build muscle. Vitamin B-12 and calcium are also found in cottage cheese.

Calories:			
6 oz	0% fat	1% fat	2% fat
Cottage Cheese	123	123	147
2 oz			
Blueberries	33		
Strawberries	19		
Raspberries	30		
Blackberries	24		
Pomegranate Seeds	47		
Grapes	38		
Banana	50		
Pineapple	28		

Ideas of what to do with cottage cheese:

- Cottage cheese on Ezekiel bread, add slices of avocado or guacamole.
- Cottage cheese on Ezekiel bread, add slices of avocado or guacamole and tomato slices
- Cut 1 banana, put it over 6 oz (0% fat) cottage cheese, and sprinkle ground cinnamon over it.
- 6 oz cottage cheese (0% fat), 10 almonds, 2 oz raspberries



VEGAN BREAKFAST OPTIONS THAT NON-VEGANS WILL LOVE

Chocolate Shake

Ingredients:

1 frozen banana (peel before freezing)

1 tablespoon of peanut butter

2 dates

½ cup of almond milk

1 tablespoon of cocoa

½ teaspoon of Konjac glucomannan powder (optional to thicken your shake)

Instructions:

1. Put the frozen banana, the peanut butter, the dates, almond milk, cocoa and Konjac glucomannan powder in a blender.
2. Blend for 20 seconds and you have your chocolate shake.



Chocolate Vegan Granola Bar

Ingredients:

- 1 ¾ cups of rolled oats**
- ½ cup of chocolate protein powder**
- 1 tablespoon of chia seeds**
- 1 tablespoon of cocoa powder**
- ¼ teaspoon of salt**
- ½ cup of peanut butter**
- 2 tablespoon of maple syrup**
- ½ cup of unsweetened almond milk**
- 2 tablespoons of chopped almonds**
- 2 tablespoons of cacao nibs**

Instructions:

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees.
2. In a medium bowl, combine the oats, protein powder, chia seeds, cocoa powder and salt.
3. In another microwavable bowl, add the peanut butter and maple syrup. Microwave on high for 30 seconds.
4. Stir them together.
5. Then add the milk and stir it all together.
6. Spread the mix into a 9x9 greased pan.
7. Place the almonds and chocolate nibs on the top and press them in.
8. Bake for 15-18 minutes.

This will yield 8 servings that are about 250 calories a serving.

Banana Beet Bowl

Ingredients:

- ¾ cup of chopped roasted beets**
- ¾ cup of frozen raspberries**
- ½ cup of unsweetened almond milk**
- 1 tablespoon of lime juice**
- 1 scoop of vanilla vegan protein powder**
- 1 tablespoon of flax meal**
- 1 ripe banana**
- 2 tablespoons of sliced almonds (optional for toppings)**
- ¼ cup of any berry (optional for toppings)**

Instructions:

1. Place all the ingredients in the blender and blend for 15-20 seconds.
2. Top off the bowl with sliced almonds and ¼ cup of any berry you like and eat it right away.

Quinoa Nut Bowl

Ingredients:

- 1 cup of unsweetened almond milk**
- 1 cup of water**
- 1 cup of quinoa**
- 2 cups of blackberries or blueberries**
- ⅓ cup of chopped almonds**
- 2 teaspoons of agave**

Instructions:

1. Combine almond milk, water and quinoa in a saucepan.
2. Bring to a boil then reduce heat and simmer for 15 minutes.
3. Stir occasionally until most of the liquid is absorbed.
4. Turn off heat and let it stand for 5-10 minutes.
5. Then add in blackberries or blueberries and mix them in. *Serves 4*

Banana Pancakes

Ingredients:

1½ cups oat flour

1 cup almond milk unsweetened

1 very ripe banana

Instructions:

Mix all 3 ingredients in a high-speed blender. Then place the mix on a hot griddle or non-stick pan. Pour in ⅓ of a cup of the batter per pancakes, cook each side till golden brown. You can add in whatever you like, but when these are done the calorie count will be 730 for all the pancakes you made.

Superhero Quick Starts

- Vegan protein shake: Mix the suggested amount of protein powder in with a cup of unsweetened almond milk and 1 banana and your choice of 1 cup of berries (300 calories)
- Apple with 1-2 tablespoons organic peanut butter/almond butter
- Banana with 1-2 tablespoons organic peanut butter/almond butter
- Low-carb cereal (cereals with less than 15 carbohydrates per serving); serve with almond milk or eat dry
- Fruit salad
- Salad for breakfast; use kale and fruit salsa or regular salsa as dressing
- 1 tablespoon of almond butter 95 calories (eat this like a spoon of ice cream)
- 1 slice Ezekiel bread with guacamole (option: squeeze a little lemon on it with chili powder)
- 1 slice of Ezekiel bread with nut butter and ½ sliced banana on top

